neither tables of fees nor orders are to be seen; the latter in very few. Regulations relative to cleanliness and order, are as necessary for debtors as for felons; the want of them have often been lamented by keepers.

An alarm bell would be extremely proper in every prison, in order to summon assistance in case of any insurrection, or general escape. The very idea of such a thing would greatly contribute to prevent the projecting of such schemes.

Finally: The care of a prison is too important to be left wholly to a gaoler; paid indeed for his attendance, but often tempted by his passions, or interest, to fail in his duty. To every prison there should be an inspector appointed; either by his colleagues in the magistracy, or by Parliament.[1] Sheriffs and magistrates have indeed this power already; and prisons are their immediate care. But some sheriffs excuse themselves from attention to this part of their duty, on account of the short duration, expense, and trouble of their office: and these gentlemen, as well as gentlemen in the commission of the peace, have no doubt been fearful of the consequence of looking into prisons. But the danger from such inspection is in great measure abated: and it may be expected that sheriffs will now engage in this business; and that among justices, and town magistrates, there may always be found one man generous enough to undertake this important service. Or if the constant trouble be thought too much for one person, it may proceed by annual, quarterly, or monthly rotation. The inspector should make his visit once in a week, changing his days. He should take with him a memorandum of all the rules, and inquire into the observance or neglect of them. He should (as is done in some of our hospitals) look into every room, to see if it be clean, etc. He should speak with every prisoner; hear all complaints; and immediately correct what he finds manifestly wrong: what he doubts of, he may refer to his brethren in office, at their next meeting. A good gaoler will be pleased with this scrutiny: it will do him honour, and confirm him in his station:

orders . . . are hung up and remain public . . . and shall inform themselves . . . and supply and redress . . . and shall expressly give in charge to every grand jury impanelled and sworn before them respectively, to make inquiries concerning the same."

[1] The Vagrant Act seventeenth George II requires that two justices visit the houses of correction "twice, or oftener if need be, in every year; and to examine into the estate and management thereof, and to report, etc." And that the justices at quarter-sessions impose fines and penalties on the governors or masters who do not keep their prisoners to hard labour, and punish and correct them according to the directions of the warrants, etc.

in case of a less worthy gaoler, the examination is more needful, in order to his being reprimanded; and, if he be incorrigible, he should be discharged. This honourable delegate should have no salary: he should engage from the noble motive of doing justice to prisoners, and service to his country. The great Dr. Young says: "If half the misery that is felt by some, were seen by others, it would shock them with horror." And the author of *Telemachus* makes this delicate remark: "The prosperous turn away their eyes from the miserable, not through insensibility, but because the sight is an interruption of their gaiety." If such motives prevail with those who think themselves under no obligation to show pity to prisoners; surely magistrates should act upon a more righteous principle, and consider what is due from them.

I have often inquired of gaolers, whether the sheriffs, justices, or town-magistrates inspect their gaols? Many of the oldest have answered: "None of those gentlemen ever looked into the dungeons, or even the wards of my gaol." Others have said: "Those gentlemen think that if they came into my gaol, they would soon be in their graves." Others: "The justices think the inside of my house too close for them; they satisfy themselves with viewing the outside." Now if magistrates continue thus negligent of their duty, a general thorough reformation of our prisons must be despaired of. What has been already obtained will soon be lost; and all will sink again into the former dreadful condition.

BRIDEWELLS

If our bridewells be not more properly conducted, sending prisoners from them to county gaols will defeat all the care of the most attentive gaolers, and the whole intention of the act for preserving the health of prisoners. And when offenders are discharged, they will spread disease and vice wherever they go: and instead of being amended, become an aggravated evil to society.

It is a shocking thing to destroy in prison the morals, the health, and (as is often done) the lives of those whom the law consigns only to hard labour and correction. One is charged with bastardy: another is abusive in a drunken quarrel: a young creature, who perhaps was never taught a moral lesson, is guilty of some petty theft—send them to bridewell for a